WIZARD SUBCLASS · D&D 2024

School of the Soul Sanctum

A scholar of Soul who harvests it from the dying, hurls it as homing orbs, blinks between spells, and risks the same hubris that ruined the Sanctum's master.

V0.1 PLAYTEST WIZARD LEVELS 3–14 INSPIRED BY HOLLOW KNIGHT

In a city of endless rain, scholars once gathered in a great sanctum to study Soul, the essence that animates every living thing. Their master sought to harvest it, hoard it, and use it to escape death. The experiments that followed left twisted failures in the Sanctum's halls and turned the master into something called the Soul Tyrant. Wizards of this school have inherited their methods. They gather Soul from the dying, hurl it as homing orbs, and blink from place to place. Most swear they won't repeat the master's mistakes.

WIZARD LEVEL	FEATURES
3rd	Soul Savant, Soul Vessel
6th	Sanctum Step, Soul Eater
10th	Sanctum Experiments
14th	Soul Tyrant

LEVEL 3

Soul Savant

Choose two Wizard spells of level 2 or lower that deal Force or Necrotic damage, and add them to your spellbook for free. Whenever you gain access to a new level of spell slots, you can add one Wizard spell of that level that deals Force or Necrotic damage to your spellbook for free.

LEVEL 3

Soul Vessel

You can store harvested Soul, up to a maximum equal to your Proficiency Bonus. You lose any stored Soul when you finish a Long Rest.

Harvesting Soul. You gain Soul in the following ways.

- **Final Breath.** When a creature you can see within 60 feet of you drops to 0 Hit Points, you gain 1 Soul.
- **Siphon the Dying.** Once per turn, when you deal damage with a Wizard cantrip to a Bloodied creature that isn't a Construct or an Undead, you gain 1 Soul.
- **Primed Vessel.** When you roll Initiative and have no Soul, you gain 1 Soul.

You can spend Soul in the following ways.

Soul Orb. As a Bonus Action, you spend 1 Soul to launch a homing orb at a creature within 60 feet of you. Make a ranged spell attack. On a hit, the target takes 2d8 Force damage, or 3d8 Force damage once you reach Wizard level 10.

Soul Surge. When you cast a spell that deals damage, you can spend 1 Soul to have one target of the spell take extra damage equal to twice your Intelligence modifier.

LEVEL 6

Sanctum Step

Once per turn, immediately after you cast a spell of level 1 or higher, you can teleport up to 15 feet to an unoccupied space you can see.

LEVEL 6

Soul Eater

Once per turn, when you damage a creature with a spell of level 1 or higher, you gain 1 Soul.

LEVEL 10

Sanctum Experiments

You've learned to bind Soul into a warrior, the Sanctum's greatest experiment. As a Magic action, you can spend 3 Soul to summon a Soul Warrior in an unoccupied space you can see within 30 feet of you. It lasts for 1 minute, until it drops to 0 Hit Points, or until you dismiss it (no action required). Once you summon it this way, you can't do so again until you finish a Long Rest unless you expend a spell slot of level 5 or higher to summon it again.

The Soul Warrior is an ally to you and your allies. In combat, it shares your Initiative count but takes its turn immediately after yours. It obeys your verbal commands (no action required by you). If you don't issue any, it attacks the nearest enemy.

Soul Warrior

Medium Undead

AC	HP	SPEED
16	5 × your Wizard level	30 ft.

Immunities: Necrotic, Poison; Charmed, Exhaustion, Frightened, Poisoned. **Senses:** Darkvision 60 ft.

Multiattack. The Soul Warrior makes two attacks, using Soul Nail or Soul Orb in any combination.

Soul Nail. *Melee Attack Roll:* your spell attack modifier, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 1d10 + your Intelligence modifier Force damage.

Soul Orb. *Ranged Attack Roll:* your spell attack modifier, range 60 ft. *Hit:* 2d6 + your Intelligence modifier Force damage.

Blink. Immediately after it makes an attack, the Soul Warrior can teleport up to 15 feet to an unoccupied space it can see.

LEVEL 14

Soul Tyrant

As a Bonus Action, you drink deeply of Soul for 1 minute, gaining the following benefits:

- **Overflowing Vessel.** Soul Orb costs no Soul, and you can use it on each of your turns.
- **Tyrant's Step.** Sanctum Step works after any spell you cast, including cantrips, and its range becomes 30 feet.
- **Devour.** When a creature you can see within 60 feet of you drops to 0 Hit Points, you regain Hit Points equal to your Wizard level.

Hubris. When the minute ends, you gain 1 level of Exhaustion. Once you use this feature, you can't do so again until you finish a Long Rest.

DESIGNER NOTES

- **Lore pulls.** Soul Vessel is the Sanctum's harvesting of Soul; Soul Orb is the Soul Master's homing orbs; Sanctum Step is his constant teleporting; Soul Eater is named for the charm found in the Sanctum; Sanctum Experiments summons a Soul Warrior, the teleporting nail-and-orb fighters made in its halls; Soul Tyrant is his ascended form, and Hubris is the price of chasing what he chased.
- **A side resource.** Soul comes from kills, cantrips against Bloodied foes, the start of each fight, and (from level 6) leveled spell damage, and is capped at your Proficiency Bonus, so spell slots stay the wizard's main engine.
- **A capstone with a cost.** Hubris makes Soul Tyrant a deliberate choice to push past your limits.
- Is Soul Orb too strong as a Bonus Action alongside a leveled spell?
- Is the Soul Warrior's damage right for level 10, and should its Hit Points or attacks scale at level 14?
- Is one level of Exhaustion the right price for Soul Tyrant?

V0.1 PLAYTEST: FIRST PUBLIC RELEASE

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